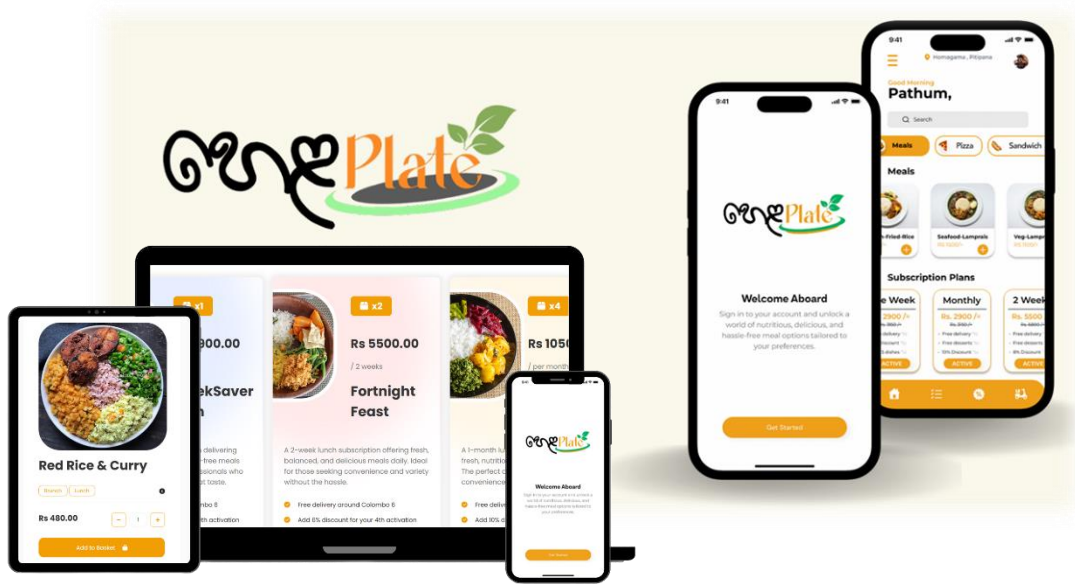


HELAPLATE BUSINESS PLAN

AI-Powered Personalized Meal Subscription Platform



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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.1 Company Overview

HelaPlate portrays an advanced model of meal delivery in Sri Lanka integrating the use of artificial intelligence technology into the food service industry. It was established by six Management Information Systems undergraduates from NSBM Green University. Our platform is designed to cater to the rising demand for healthy and convenient meal options for busy professionals in Colombo's corporate landscape.

Customers on a subscription plan receive precisely curated meals to match their health records, dietary restrictions, and lifestyle choices. Based on feedback, our proprietary AI algorithm ensures diverse meals are suggested while maintaining optimal nutrition and tailored to the user's individual dietary preferences

1.2 Mission Statement

“To ensure nutrition, convenience, and unrivaled taste while promoting wellness through fresh, balanced, and tailored meals designed to enable effortless integration into any lifestyle.”

1.3 Vision Statement

“Empowering people to live healthier, happier lives through nourishing and delicious meals powered by intelligent technology.”

1.4 Key Success Factors

- **AI-Driven Personalization:** Advanced algorithms for customized meal planning
- **Strategic Market Focus:** Targeting busy corporate professionals in high-density areas
- **Geographic Advantage:** Initial focus on Colombo 6 for optimal logistics
- **Cost-Effective Model:** University-backed startup with LKR 100,000 initial investment
- **Technical Expertise:** Strong MIS foundation for technology development

1.5 Financial Highlights

- Startup Capital: LKR 100,000
- Target Market Size: corporate employees (initial phase)
- Revenue Model: Subscription-based with three-tier pricing
- Break-Even Timeline: Month 8
- Year 1 Revenue Projection: LKR 2,355,000

1.6 Funding Requirements

- Phase 1 (Launch): LKR 100,000 (Available)
- Phase 2 (Growth): LKR 300,000 (Month 6)
- Phase 3 (Expansion): LKR 500,000 (Month 12)

2. GENERAL COMPANY DESCRIPTION

HelaPlate is a personalized subscription-based meal service, utilizing the latest in artificial intelligence (AI) technology and culinary perfection. The primary objective of the company is to deliver fresh, healthy, and customized meals directly to its clients: initially, this will be the business or corporate industry people of Colombo.

(URL INTRO: https://youtu.be/9Jrho-NQ-QQ?si=rXVZPDZNx5eJcAP_)

2.1 Legal Structure:

HelaPlate is currently operated as a partnership between 6 undergraduate students enrolled at the Management Information Systems (MIS) program of the NSBM Green University, who intend to incorporate as a Private Limited Company once it expands.

2.2 Core Values:

- **Health First:** Put nutrition first and do not compromise on flavor.
- **Innovation:** Personalization by using AI to make the consumer experience better.
- **Sustainability:** Making use of environmentally friendly materials in the package and supporting local farmers.
- **Service oriented to the Customer:** Working based on customer feedback and demand for the development of the platform.

2.3 Advantages over competitors:

- **Meal customization with the help of AI:** It is possible to provide meals that match dietary preferences and needs exactly.
- **University-Backed R&D:** University-based R&D can be conducted on platforms and make use of MIS expertise.
- **Lean Operations:** Getting maximum utility out of resources to keep prices competitive.
- **In-depth Market Information:** Focusing on a large, in-demand business market.

HelaPlate's long-term goals include growing its business throughout Colombo, branching out into breakfast and dinner, and eventually entering other nations in the area.

3. MARKET ANALYSIS

3.1 Industry Overview

The Sri Lankan market for food delivery has expanded significantly, particularly in the post-pandemic period, with increasing demand for convenient meals. The majority of existing services are more about convenience rather than health and personalization, leaving a significant market gap for HelaPlate's value proposition.

Industry Characteristics:

- Market size: LKR 15 + billion annually
- Growth rate: 25-30% year on year
- Key drivers: Urbanization, dual-income households, health consciousness
- Adoption of technology: rising use of smartphones and acceptance of electronic payments

3.2 Target Market Analysis

Primary Market:

- Location: Colombo 6 corporate employees
- Demographics: 25-45 years old, middle to upper-middle income (LKR 75,000 or more per month)
- Size: 5,000 office staff in target location
- Initial Target: 500 employees (10% market penetration)

Market Characteristics:

- High disposable income and health awareness
- Busy lifestyle with limited meal preparation time
- Dependence on unhealthy fast-food services
- Readiness to pay a premium for quality and convenience

3.3 Market Research Findings

- Based on primary research conducted amongst target groups:
- 86.7% find it difficult to adopt healthy meal practices
- 90% are interested in value-added meal subscription services
- Lunch is the highest opportunity for external sourcing
- Average willingness to pay: LKR 400-600 per meal

3.4 Competitive Analysis

Direct Competitors:

1. PickMe Food

- Strengths: Brand recall, network of delivery
- Weaknesses: Uncertainty of personalization, thin health focus
- Market share: 35%

2. Uber Eats

- Strengths: Technology platform, range of restaurants
- Weaknesses: Uncertainty of meal planning, inconsistent quality
- Market share: 25%

3. Local Catering Services

- Strengths: Established relationships, bulk ordering
- Weaknesses: Thin personalization, low tech
- Market share: 20%

Competitive Positioning: HelaPlate competes on AI-based personalization, consistent health focus, and assured quality standards beyond the ability of existing competitors.

3.5 Market Trends

- **Health Consciousness:** Increasing awareness of the role of nutrition in productivity and health
- **Technology Adoption:** More comfort with AI-recommended suggestions
- **Subscription Economy:** More acceptance of subscription models
- **Corporate Wellness:** More employer investment in employee health programs

4. PRODUCTS AND SERVICES

A meal subscription based on AI is the main product of HelaPlate. The product is designed to facilitate healthy eating by removing the inconveniences of shopping in grocery stores, planning meals, and monitoring nutritional information.

4.1 Core Product: Personalized Meal Subscriptions

AI-Powered Meal Planning

- The customers fill out a questionnaire regarding their diet and health when signing up.
- AI platforms recommend diets based on dietary needs, taste, and health associations.
- The system learns by reviews and ratings given by users and improves later suggestions accordingly.
- Users can monitor the balance of their nutrients and the number of calories consumed using nutrition monitoring functions.

Subscription Plans

- **Basic Plan:** 3meals /week - LKR 1500
- **Standard Plan:** 5 meals /week - LKR 2,200
- **Premium Plan:** 7 meals/week - LKR 2800

Flexible delivery scheduling and customizable menus on all plans customizable menus are included.

Meal Features

- Fresh ingredients sourced locally and from a known vendor.
- Various types of dieting opportunities, vegan, low-carb, high-protein, vegetarian, etc.
- Nutritional information of any meal is displayed.
- Green marketing package.

4.2 Additional Services

- Nutritional Consulting: One-to-one consultations with dietitians both on and remotely.
- Corporate wellness programs are unique packages designed to support employees' well-being.
- Special Dietary Requests: Options of how to feed people with allergies, diabetes, and gluten intolerances.
- Corporate subscriptions: Provide massive office orders at a specially cut price.

Unlike other food delivery businesses that only concentrate on convenience, HelaPlate combines high-quality, health-conscious meal preparation with technology-driven customization. Our strategy guarantees that each meal is nourishing and customized to meet the demands of the client.

5. MARKETING PLAN

5.1 Positioning

HelaPlate is the smart meal solution for busy Sri Lankan professionals who are concerned about their health but lack the time to invest in proper nutrition. By combining AI-driven personalization with healthy, locally sourced ingredients, we're delivering a dining experience that's as healthy as it is convenient.

5.2 Target Market

Primary Market Segment

- Location: Colombo 6 corporate hubs
- Demographics: Professionals aged 25 - 45
- Income Level: LKR 75,000 monthly
- Lifestyle: Health-conscious, time-poor, and seeking convenience

Market Characteristics

- strong understanding of how nutrition affects wellbeing and productivity
- Reliance on ready-to-eat or fast food due to time constraints
- Willingness to pay a premium for quality and consistency

5.3 Competitive Advantage

- AI-Driven Personalization: Personalized meal planning based on diet type, taste, and health goals
- Health-Focused Brand: Meals designed to deliver long-term health, not just convenience
- Quality Consistency: Codified recipes and quality control for a consistent customer experience
- Corporate Outreach Focus: Direct partnerships with employers for bulk subscriptions

5.4 Marketing Mix (4Ps)

Product Strategy

- Variety, culturally inspired menus blending Sri Lankan cuisine with healthy international food
- Regular menu updates based on seasonal produce and customer feedback
- Special diets (keto, diabetic, vegetarian, etc.)

Pricing Strategy

- **Premium tiered subscription pricing:**
 - ✓ Basic: LKR 1,500 (3 meals/week)
 - ✓ Standard: LKR 2,200 (5 meals/week)
 - ✓ Premium: LKR 2,800 (7 meals/week)
- Corporate discounting (15% for orders of 20+ meals)
- Loyalty rewards and promotions for first-time customers

Promotion Strategy

- Phase 1 (Months 1-3): Direct targeting of corporate offices, free trials, sponsorship of wellness seminars
- Phase 2 (Months 4-6): Social media campaigns (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn), referral rewards, targeted Google Ads
- Phase 3 (Months 7-12): Partnerships with health influencers, affiliation with corporate wellness programs

Place (Distribution Strategy)

- Direct delivery to workplaces at lunchtime
- Tactical pickup points in high-traffic locations
- Future expansion to home delivery in target districts

5.5 Customer Acquisition Plan

- Months 1-2: Build brand recognition through corporate visits and complimentary trials (50 trials).
- Months 3-4: Launch social media content marketing on productivity and wellness benefits.
- Months 5-6: Secure agreements with HR departments for corporate wellness programs and bulk subscription agreements.

By the end of Year 1, HelaPlate aims to secure 250 more active subscribers, expand operations to Colombo 3 and Colombo 7, and establish itself as the go-to healthy meal subscription brand for Sri Lankan professionals.

6. OPERATIONS PLAN

6.1 Production

Process Flow:

- Ingredient Procurement: Daily purchases from wholesale markets in Colombo between 5:00 AM - 6:00 AM, with quality inspections on immediate receipt.
- Meal Preparation: Between 6:00 AM - 10:00 AM, through standardized recipes based on customer dietary profiles generated by the AI recommendation engine.
- Packaging: Eco-friendly, portion-controlled packaging with nutritional labels between 10:00 AM - 11:00 AM.

Delivery:

- Corporate deliveries: Between 11:30 AM - 1:30 PM
- Individual deliveries: Between 12:00 PM - 6:00 PM
- End-of-Day Operations: 4:00 PM --5:00 PM cleaning, sanitation, and preparation for the next day.

Quality Control:

- HACCP-compliant processes, daily temperature checks, and hygiene management.
- Regular taste tests to establish consistency and flavor benchmarks.
- Continuous improvement through the integration of customer feedback.

6.2 Location

- Type: 500 sq. ft. HACCP-certified commercial kitchen
- Location Advantage: Central Colombo for delivery route efficiency and quick access to suppliers
- Rent: LKR 25,000/month (including utilities)
- Facilities: Commercial cooking appliances, refrigeration, insulated delivery containers, storage area, and employee workspace.

6.3 Legal Environment

- Business Registration: Partnership among six NSBM MIS students (proposed change to Private Limited Company)
- Licenses & Permits: Food safety permit, health department permit, HACCP certification.
- Compliance: Sri Lanka's food handling legislation, labor legislation, and data protection legislation for customer information.
- Insurance: Product liability insurance, general business insurance, and cyber liability insurance for data protection.

6.4 Personnel

- **Phase 1 (Months 1-6):**
 - ✓ 6 Co-founders (part-time)
 - ✓ 2 part-time kitchen staff
 - ✓ 1 part-time customer service representative
- **Phase 2 (Months 7-12):**
 - ✓ 4 full-time kitchen staff
 - ✓ 2 delivery drivers
 - ✓ 1 full-time customer service manager
 - ✓ 1 part-time nutrition consultant
- **Phase 3 (Year 2+):**
 - ✓ Founders transition to full-time roles
 - ✓ More managers and operational staff according to growth

Training: All staff are trained in food safety, quality control, and customer service before operations commencement.

6.5 Inventory

- Type: Fresh produce, proteins, grains, spices, eco-friendly packaging materials.
- Value in Stock: Daily turnover with minimal storage to preserve freshness; 15% allowance for high-demand days.

- Control: Stock levels tracked by electronic management system linked to the ordering system.
- Seasonal Planning: Menu adjustments based on ingredient availability and cost optimization.

6.6 Suppliers

- Primary Suppliers: Colombo traditional wholesale markets for fresh vegetables and meat.
- Backup Sources: Secondary vendors to minimize supply chain risks.
- Quality Standards: Daily inspection of deliveries for freshness, hygiene, and conformance to food safety regulations.
- Payment Terms: Net 7 days for positive cash flow.

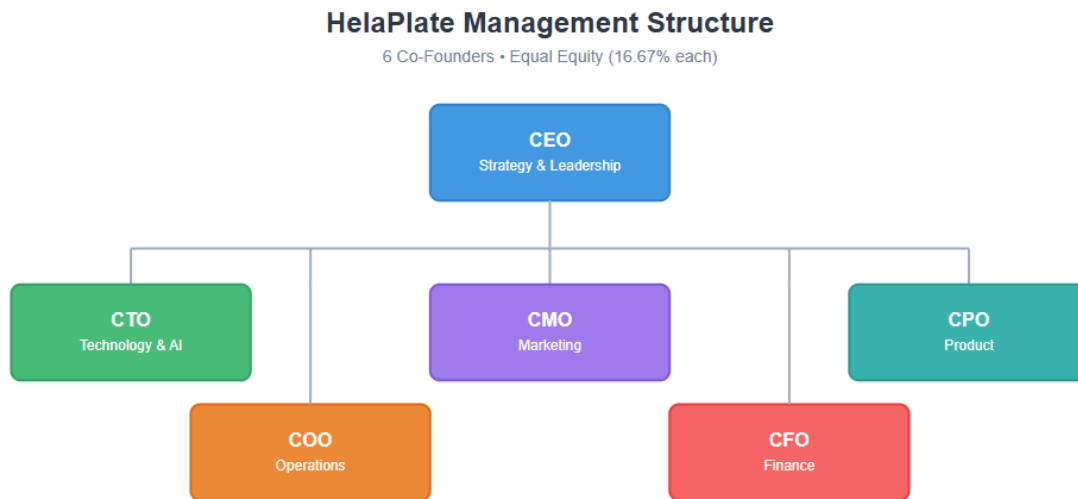
6.7 Credit Policies

- Customer Credit: Not given to individual customers; corporate customers receive credit terms by agreement.
- Corporate Payment Terms: 15-30 days according to contract.
- Supplier Credit: Short-term supplier credit terms to maximize cash flow.
- Receivables Management: Computerized follow-ups and reminders for overdue payment.

7. MANAGEMENT AND ORGANIZATION

7.1 Organizational Structure

HelaPlate is led by six co-founders from NSBM Green University's MIS program, each holding equal equity (16.67%). To guarantee operational efficiency, roles are separated according to expertise.



7.2 Professional & Advisory Support

- **Academic Advisors:** NSBM faculty in business, technology, and nutrition.
- **Industry Mentors:** Food service entrepreneurs and startup founders.
- **Legal & Compliance Advisors:** Assist with regulatory approvals, contracts, and food safety compliance.
- **Nutrition Consultants:** Provide expertise in menu design and diet planning

7.3 Staffing Plan

Phase 1 (Months 1-6):

- 6 Co-founders (part-time)
- 2 part-time kitchen assistants
- 1 part-time customer service representative

Phase 2 (Months 7-12):

- 4 full-time kitchen staff
- 2 delivery riders
- 1 full-time customer service manager
- 1 part-time nutrition consultant

Phase 3 (Year 2):

- Founders move to full-time leadership roles
- Hiring of department managers, marketing executives, and additional kitchen/delivery teams

7.4 Continuity Planning

To ensure business stability in the event of unexpected leadership changes:

- Cross-training among management roles.
- Documentation of all key processes.
- Advisory board guidance for interim decision-making.

8. PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

HelaPlate is formed with six co-equal members with every owner holding 16.67% share. For purposes of demonstrating financial capability, creditability, and commitment, individual financial statements of all founders are shown in Appendix A (Confidential).

Each statement includes:

- Assets: Cash savings, bank accounts, investments, property, vehicles, and other assets of value.
- Liabilities: Credit card debt, mortgages, loans, and other outstanding obligations are examples
- Net Worth: Total Assets -Total Liabilities

Purpose:

- To demonstrate the founders' capability to contribute towards startup funds.
- To assure lenders and investors about the financial stability of the team.
- To recognize the possible collateral that may assist with funding in case of a need.

A confidential summary table of total assets, liabilities, and net worth for each founder is maintained and will be made available to authorized stakeholders upon request.

9. FINANCIAL PLAN

The financial plan outlines HelaPlate's projected revenues, expenses, cash flow, and break-even analysis. All figures are based on market research, subscription pricing models, and operational cost estimates.

9.1 Startup Costs

Initial capital requirement: LKR 100,000, funded by equal contributions from all six founders.

Category	Amount (LKR)	% of Total
Kitchen Equipment & Setup	35,000	35%
Technology Development	20,000	20%
Initial Inventory	15,000	15%
Marketing & Branding	12,000	12%
Legal & Registration	8,000	8%
Contingency Fund	10,000	10%
Total	100,000	100%

9.2 Revenue Projections (Year 1)

Month	Subscribers	Avg. Meals per Sub	Revenue (LKR)	Cumulative Revenue
1	15	4.0	22,500	22,500
3	50	4.5	90,000	165,000
6	110	5.0	220,000	683,800
9	180	5.2	374,400	1,630,200
12	250	5.5	550,000	3,070,600

Year 1 Total Revenue: LKR 3,070,600

9.3 Cost Structure (at 150 Subscribers per Month)

Expense Category	Monthly Cost (LKR)	% of Total
Food Costs (COGS)	125,000	50%
Kitchen Rent & Utilities	28,000	11%
Delivery Costs	20,000	8%
Technology & Software	10,000	4%
Marketing & Advertising	25,000	10%
Staff Salaries	30,000	12%
Other Operating Expenses	12,000	5%

9.3 Break-Even Analysis

- Fixed Monthly Costs: LKR 95,000
- Variable Cost per Meal: LKR 280
- Average Revenue per Meal: LKR 480
- Contribution Margin per Meal: LKR 200

9.4 Cash Flow Projections (First 6 Months)

Month	Opening Cash	Revenue	Expenses	Net Cash Flow	Closing Cash
0	100,000	0	35,000	-35,000	65,000
1	65,000	22,500	45,000	-22,500	42,500
3	30,000	90,000	85,000	5,000	35,000
6	93,800	220,000	155,000	65,000	158,800

9.5 Funding Requirements

- **Phase 1 (Launch):** LKR 100,000 (already secured)
- **Phase 2 (Growth – Month 6):** LKR 300,000 for equipment upgrades, marketing scale-up, and staff expansion.
- **Phase 3 (Expansion – Month 12):** LKR 500,000 for geographic expansion, technology upgrades, and working capital.

10. REFINING THE PLAN

10.1 For Bankers:

- Loan Requirement: LKR 300,000 (Months 6) for equipment, personnel, and marketing.
- Repayment: 3 years, monthly payments.
- Impact: Breaks even by Month 6, increases delivery capacity.
- Collateral: Kitchen equipment, technology assets.

10.2 For Investors:

- Funding: LKR 300,000 (Month 6), LKR 500,000 (Month 12).
- Offer of Equity: Negotiable percentage equity.
- ROI: Growth to 2,000+ subscribers in 3 years.
- Exit: IPO, buyout, or franchise repurchase.

10.3 Service Business Focus:

- Pricing: 35-40% gross margin per plan.
- Quality: HACCP certification, daily quality checks.
- Retention: Rewards for loyalty, corporate bulk deals.
- Subcontracting: Outsourced delivery (Phase 1), internal thereafter.

10.4 High-Tech Focus:

- R&D: AI engine version 1.0 in 6 months.
- IP: Secret algorithm, secure data protection.
- Talent: Equity-based incentives for tech team.

10.5 Retail/Pickup Points:

- Location: Colombo 6 hub near offices.
- Customer Service: Replacement/refund facility for disappointing meal.

11. APPENDICES

11.1 Market Research Data

- Results of customer survey (86.7% struggle to keep up with healthy meals, 90% would be interested in subscriptions).
- Competitor pricing comparison (PickMe Food, Uber Eats, local caterers).
- Industry growth forecasts (25–30% YOY).

11.2 Financial Models

- Financial projections in detail for 3 years.
- Break-even analysis (95 subscribers).
- Cash flow projections for the first 12 months.

11.3 Technical Specifications

- AI recommendation engine design.
- Wireframes for mobile app (iOS & Android).
- Data security measures (encryption, backups).

11.4 Legal & Regulatory

- Business registration papers.
- HACCP compliance certificate.
- Intellectual property protection plan.

11.5 Marketing Materials

- Brand identity and logo standards.
- Sample corporate outreach brochures.
- Social media campaign designs.